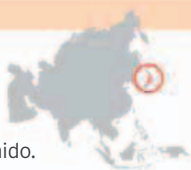


LOCATION

Extends from Hiroshima in the west of the island of Honshu, eastward and northward to the most southerly tip of Hokkaido.

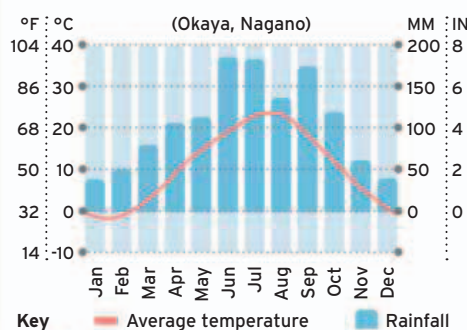


CHINA



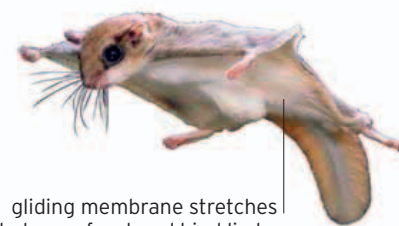
CLIMATE

The region's climate is seasonal and temperate. Temperatures can drop below freezing during winter, but may reach 86°F (30°C) in summer.



Siberian flying squirrel

Pteromys volans



gliding membrane stretches between front and hind limbs

Using its sail-like gliding membrane and flattened tail for lift, the flying squirrel is capable of gliding 245 ft (75 m) or more between trees. Old-growth forests are this nocturnal mammal's preferred habitat, as the trees provide food as well as woodpecker holes, which it uses as a nest site.



- ↔ 5–9 in (13–23 cm)
- ⚖ 3–6 oz (85–170 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌿 Nuts, buds, leaves
- 🏠



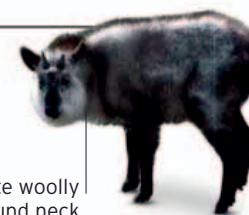
E. Europe to E. Asia

SEASONAL EATER

In summer, the Siberian flying squirrel feeds mainly on fresh aspen, birch, and alder leaves.

Japanese serow

Capricornis crispus



white woolly ruff around neck

A small relative of goats, both male and female serows have short horns, and a long, woolly coat to withstand harsh winters. Diurnal browsers, they often retreat to a cave at night. They mark their territory with scent, chosen so they can exploit a wide range of plant food sources.



- ↔ 4 ft (1.2 m)
- ⚖ 68–106 lb (31–48 kg)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🌿 Grass, leaves, acorns
- 🏠



E. Asia (Japan)

GOING SOLO

In winter, serows adopt a solitary lifestyle to make the most of the scarce food resources in their territory.

tree in the Nihonkai forest

RODENT CONTROL
The Japanese weasel was originally native to just three of Japan's islands, but has been introduced by humans to most of the other islands to control rodent pests. In winter, this efficient predator hunts mice and rats in tunnels beneath the snow.

JAPANESE WEASEL

